* 'I feel that China's relations with many of its neighbours, such as Vietnam, Mongolia and India are very complicated and changeable. But Chinese scholars have done little to research the history of these relations. Scholars and policymakers know little about the neighbourhood. I believe that historians should be held responsible for this inability to provide policymakers with the relevant background knowledge.'—H-Diplo Essay 267—Shen Zhihua, in the series Learning the Scholar's Craft: Reflections of Historians and International Relations Scholars, 15 September 2020, https://hdiplo.or/to/E267. Shen is Professor of History and Director of the Centre for Cold War International History Studies, East China Normal University, Shanghai, and a pre-eminent scholar of Cold War history in China.
* Rakesh Sood, joint secretary (Disarmament and International Security Affairs).